NOVA

Sweater

The Knit Purl Girl

NOVA SWEATER - V1

The Nova Sweater is my free release for early 2024. Inspired by traditional Nordic knitting, it is a sweater with a circular yoke that is worked both top down and in the round. The yoke is decorated with stranded colourwork that is fun and easy to knit. First, a double-folded collar is worked. You will then work the yoke, all of which is charted and shaped with simple yarnover increases, before starting some German short rows to give the sweater a bit of extra structure. You then divide the sleeve and body sections of the yoke, cast on some underarm stitches, and proceed to work the body. You will then work the sleeves.

Thank you so much for your support of TKPG over the past year; I'm so grateful and so pleased to be able to share this pattern with you as thanks for everything.

If you really enjoyed this pattern and would like to support my work financially, my Ko-Fi page can be found here.

Sophie xxx

Materials & Fit

Notions: 3.5 mm [US 4] (40-, 80- and 100-cm [16-, 32- and 40-in] cord) and 4.5 mm [US 7] (40-, 60-, 80-, and 100-cm [16-, 32- and/or 40-in] cord) circular needles. You may also find some 3.5 mm [US 4] and 4.5 mm [US 7] double-pointed knitting needles useful for the sleeves. If your tension tends to be change when working colourwork, you may also find some 4 mm [US 6] and/or 5 mm [US 8] (40-, 60-, 80-, and 100-cm [16-, 32- and/or 40-in] cord) circular needles useful for the yoke, but this will depend on your personal tension. You will also need a few stitch markers, a darning needle, and some spare needles/scrap yarn/stitch holders where the stitches of the sleeves will rest. I would also recommend having some clip-on markers at hand.

Yarn: Approximately 7 (7-8) 8 (9), 9, (9-10) 10 (10), 11 (12) 13 (14) skeins in your main colour and approximately 1 (1) 1 (1-2), 1-2 (1-2) 2 (2), 2 (2) 2 (2) skeins in your contrast colour of Lopi Léttlopi (100% Icelandic wool; 50 g = 100 m [109 yds]).

If you want to substitute these yarns for alternatives, I estimate that you will need approximately 750 (775) 825 (875), 925 (1,000) 1,050 (1,100), 1,200 (1,325) 1,425 (1,550) m [800 (850) 900 (960), 1,020 (1,080) 1,140 (1,200), 1,310 (1,430) 1,560 (1,780) yds] of your main colour. I estimate that you will need

approximately 76 (80) 84 (88), 92 (96) 100 (104), 112 (120) 132 (140) m [84 (87) 92 (97), 100 (106) 110 (114), 123 (132) 145 (154) yds] of your contrast colour.

For ease of reference, I have rounded the figures given for the main colour here to the nearest 25 m, and have rounded the conversion to yds to the nearest 10 yds. However, I have given the exact figures for my estimates of contrast colour in case you are looking to use up scrap yarn. Please also note that this pattern has not been tested and so the numbers given here are approximations based on the number of stitches in the pattern and the sample garment. If in doubt, I highly recommend ordering more yarn than is recommended here.

For reference, I used 390 g of my main colour yarn (Galaxy 1707) and 44 g of my contrast colour (White 0051), which works out to be 8 balls in my main colour and 1 ball in my contrast colour for my Size D sample garment. However, I prefer a cropped fit and so the total length (not including the collar) of my sample is only 46 cm [18.5 in]. I have therefore suggested a bit more main colour yarn for this size than I actually used.

Tension: 20 sts x 24 rounds in Stockinette stitch on 4.5 mm [US 7] needles = 10 x 10 cm [4 x 4 in]. Make sure to wash and block your swatch for the most accurate results. Please note, though, that I have unusually tight row gauge. You may wish to go up or down a needle size, working in 0.25/0.5 mm [US 0.5] increments as needed to meet gauge.

Sizing and ease: The Nova Sweater has a recommended positive ease of between 5-10 cm [2-4 in] for **Sizes A-H**, and 5-15 cm [2-6 in] for **Sizes I-L**. If you would prefer more or less ease, however, feel free to change size to achieve your desired fit. Use the schematic below to find your size based on your chest measurement.

Size: A (B) C (D), E (F) G (H), I (J) K (L)

Chest measurement (cm): 75-80 (80-85) 85-90 (90-95), 95-100 (100-105) 105-110 (110-115), 115-125 (125-135) 135-145 (145-155)
Chest measurement (in): 30-32 (32-34) 34-36 (36-38), 38-40 (40-42) 42-44 (44-46), 46-50 (50-54) 54-58 (58-62)

Actual circumference of garment (cm): 85 (90) 95 (100), 105 (110) 115 (120), 130 (140) 150 (160)
Actual circumference of garment (in): 33.5 (35.5) 37.5 (39.5), 41.5 (43.25) 45.25

(47.25), 51.25 (55.25) 59 (64)

Actual yoke depth (cm): 20 (20.5) 21 (21.5), 22 (22.5) 22.5 (23), 24 (24.5) 25.5 (26.5)
Actual yoke depth (in): 7.75 (8) 8.25 (8.5), 8.75 (8.75) 8.75 (9), 9.5 (9.75) 10 (10.5)

Sleeve circumference at upper bicep (cm): 29 (30) 31 (33), 34 (36) 37 (38), 41 (45) 48.5 (52.5)
Sleeve circumference at upper bicep (in): 11.5 (12) 12.5 (13.25), 13.5 (14.5) 14.75 (15.25), 16.5 (18) 19.5 (21)

Recommended sleeve length (cm): 45, with options to modify included in the pattern
Recommended sleeve length (in): 18, with options to modify included in the pattern

Recommended length from bottom of collar to hem (cm): 50.5 (51.5) 52.5 (53.5), 54.5 (55.5) 56.5 (57.5), 59.5 (61) 62.5 (64)
Recommended length from bottom of collar to hem (in): 20.25 (20.5) 21 (21.5), 21.75 (22.25) 22.5 (23), 23.75 (24.5) 25 (25.5)

Please note that all measurements given in inches are rounded to the nearest quarter inch using a conversion rate of 2.5 cm = 1 in.

Techniques

Double-folded collar: This is a technique that is often used in sweaters and for the brims of hats. Essentially, you work the rib to twice your desired length with a round of purl stitches halfway through. You then fold your knitting over on itself using the round of purl stitches as guide, so that the cast-on edge sits inside your circular needle. When you go to work the first stitch of the round, you need to follow the column of stitches back down to the cast-on, pick up the corresponding stitch along the cast-on edge, and work them together. It is a bit fiddly, but the results are so worth it. This video offers a good explanation, though personally I find it easier to put the picked-up stitch on my left-hand needle: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nL_5UF1e9Jk

Knitting in the round: Knitting in the round is a technique that allows you to work

pieces of knitting in one go without seams. You are knitting a big tube rather than flat panels. The key point to remember is that the RS of the work is always facing you (except when working short rows, see below). It's much less complicated than it seems but if this is your first time working in the round, you may find this tutorial helpful: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_BNZx2Nt8Ng

Reading a knitting chart: Reading a chart can seem intimidating, but I promise it is straightforward once you have got your head around it. In this case, you always read the chart from right to left and from bottom to top. Each black square represents a stitch worked in your main colour, whilst the white squares represent stitches worked in your contrast colour. The grey squares represent stitches that you will form further along in the chart.

Two-stranded colourwork: In stranded colourwork, you alternate between using your main colour and a contrast colour. For this pattern, I recommend that you hold your main colour in your dominant hand and to hold your contrast colour in your non-dominant hand; or to hold both yarns in one hand but position your main colour closest to your work and your contrast colour further away, with or without a colourwork ring.

If this is your first colourwork project, the best way to learn is to dive right in and experiment to find the method that feels most comfortable to you. Just be mindful not to work too tightly, as this is a common issue in colourwork knitting, and to catch your floats when the float is more than, for me, 4 stitches (but I am a very tight knitter so you may be able to get away with a longer float).

For a more thorough explanation of this, I recommend this blogpost by Very Pink Knits which offers a range of tutorials on stranded colourwork: http://verypink.com/2011/01/13/learn-to-knit-fair-isle-baby-or-adult-cap/. I also recommend watching this video for help on catching floats: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5Fsbwg4xTlw

Make 1 left: This is a left-leaning increase. Insert your needle under the strand of yarn between the stitch you have just knit and the next stitch from front to back and place it on your left-hand needle. Knit it through the back loop so that it is twisted.

Yarn-over increases: This pattern only uses yarn-over increases. These are very simple to work and blend in seamlessly with the colourwork. To form a yarn over, simply bring your working yarn in front of your work and wrap it around your

right-hand needle to form an extra stitch. In the next round, you will need to work these yarn over stitches through the back loop to prevent holes. This is made clear both in the chart and the pattern.

German short rows: To work this technique, knit across the row until you are told to 'turn'/'use the next stitch to turn your work'. Turn your work around so that you are looking at the wrong side. Making sure that your working yarn is in front of your work, slip the last stitch you knitted from your left-hand needle to your right-hand needle. Pull the working yarn over the top of your needle tightly, so that you can see a little inverted 'V' rather than a normal, single stitch. Bring your working yarn all the way around to the front of your work again and continue to purl until you need to turn your work again. When you reach this point, turn your work so that the right side is once again facing you and, with the working yarn in front of the work, once again slip the last stitch you purled from the left-hand needle to the right. Again, pull the working yarn so that you can see the inverted 'V' but, this time, keep the working yarn behind the work, so that you are ready to knit. It is normal for the turning stitches to look a little distorted. When you next work these GSR stitches, simply knit through both the legs of the stitch in a similar way to a K2tog.

Please note that the 'V' stitch is referred to as the 'GSR stitch' here.
I recommend watching this video by Purl Soho, which provides a good demonstration and explanation of the technique:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a3S9cI47PYw

Casting on in the middle of a row: You will need to cast on new stitches in the middle of a row when you separate the body from the sleeves. It's not particularly difficult but can be tricky for beginners. You can either use the backwards-loop/thumb method, or the knitted method. If you use the knitted method, you will need to knit into the back of the new stitches on the next round. I tend to prefer the backwards-loop/thumb method because it is faster, but the two cast-on methods yield very similar results in practice. The following tutorial is very helpful and explains the differences: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bTgT7kE1c_k&t=145s

Knit 2 together: This is a right-leaning decrease. Knit two stitches together as if they were one. If you get stuck, this tutorial is good:
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PInQ-iOi29M

Slip, slip, knit: This is a left-leaning decrease. Slip the next stitch in your row or

round from the left-hand needle to the right-hand needle knit-wise, repeat for the next stitch, pass them both back to the left-hand needle and work them together through the back loop. If you prefer, you can use any other left-leaning decrease, e.g., Sl1, k1, PSSO or K2tog TBL. Try this SSK tutorial if you get stuck: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DgaG5J-fuFM

Tubular cast-off: A tubular cast-off is a type of sewn bind-off that gives the illusion of the rib stitch rolling over on itself towards the wrong side of your work. This produces a really neat and professional finish without a harsh line at the end. Alternatively, you can work an elastic bind off – but I recommend going down at least 1 needle size or the edge will fan out. I really do recommend learning the tubular bind-off, though, as the finish is so beautiful, and it really isn't too difficult once you've got your head around it. This tutorial is helpful: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FNbanlVzbxw

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Stitches

Stockinette stitch (worked in the round)
Round 1: Knit all stitches.

1x1 rib (worked in the round)
Round 1: *Knit 1, purl 1*.

Abbreviations

BOR: Beginning of round
CC: Contrast colour
K2tog: Knit 2 together
MC: Main colour
M1L: Make 1 left
RS: Right side
SSK: Slip, slip, knit
TBL: Through the back loop
WS: Wrong side
WYIB: With yarn in front
WYIF: With yarn in back
YO: Yarn over
***...*:** Repeat all instructions from * to * until otherwise stated.

Collar

Using 4.5 mm [US 7] circular needles (any length is fine) and the long-tail method, cast on 76 (80) 84 (88), 92 (96) 100 (104), 108 (112) 114 (116) stitches.

Change to 3.5 mm [US 4] circular needles with a 40-cm [16-in] cord.

Join to work in the round and place a BOR marker between the first and last stitch of the round. The BOR will sit at the mid-back.

Work the collar as follows:

Rounds 1-12: Slip BOR marker, *knit 1, purl 1* to the end of the round.

Round 13: Slip BOR marker, purl all stitches.

Rounds 14-25: Slip BOR marker, *knit 1, purl 1* to the end of the round.

In the next round, you will work each live stitch together with the corresponding stitch of the cast-on edge to form a double-folded collar. This can be intimidating and a bit fiddly if you are new to the technique, but it gets easier when you get into the flow of it. You may find it helpful to place a clip-on stitch marker every 5-10 stitches, on both the live stitches and the cast-on edge to ensure that your collar doesn't become skewed. Work this as follows:

Fold the collar in half along the row of purl stitches so that the cast-on edge is sitting inside of your circular needle and the purl bumps are facing RS out. *Look back down the column of the next stitch on your left-hand needle and identify the cast-on stitch for that column. Put it on the left-hand needle and knit it together with the live stitch, as you would a K2tog.* Repeat this process from * to * until all of the stitches have been worked with their corresponding cast-on stitch. Matching up the clip-on stitch markers on the live stitches and cast-on edge will help here.

Set up the yoke (Sizes I-L only)

You will now work a series of increases in preparation for the chart. To do so, you will need to change to your 4.5 mm [US 7] needle with a 40-cm [16-in] cord. These increases are worked as follows:

Size I: Slip BOR marker, *knit 27, M1L* 4 times *(+4 stitches)*.

Size J: Slip BOR marker, *knit 14, M1L* 8 times *(+8 stitches)*.

Size K: Slip BOR marker, *knit 6, M1L* 6 times, *knit 7, M1L* 6 times, *knit 6, M1L* 6 times *(+18 stitches)*.

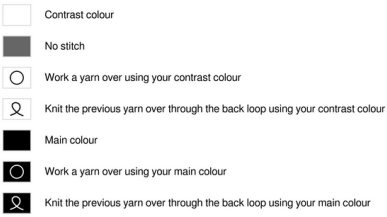
Size L: Slip BOR marker, *knit 4 M1L* 2 times, *knit 5, M1L* 20 times, *knit 4, M1L* 2 times *(+24 stitches)*.

You have increased a total of 4 (8) 18 (24) stitches and now have a total of 112 (120) 132 (140) stitches.

Begin the chart (all sizes)

To reiterate, you now have a total of 76 (80) 84 (88), 92 (96) 100 (104), 112 (120) 132 (140) stitches. If you have not done so already, you should now change to a 4.5 mm [US 7] circular needle with a 40-cm [16-in] cord.

You will now join your CC yarn and begin to follow the stranded colourwork pattern in **Chart 1**. The charted pattern repeat is the same for all sizes, but the number of repeats varies.



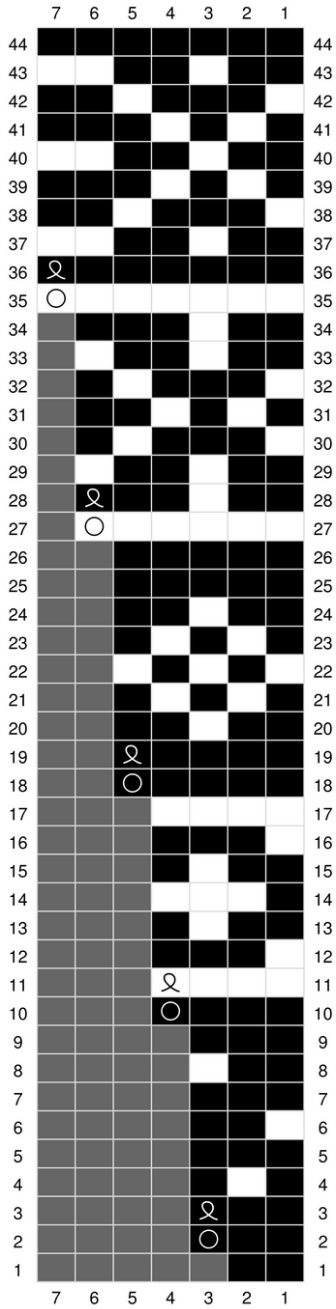


Chart 1

Again, please keep in mind that working stranded colourwork can affect your tension. Check your swatches and go up or down to a 5-mm [US 8] or 4-mm [US 6] needle, or to the needle size you need to achieve the correct tension.

You will work the charted pattern repeat 38 (40) 42 (44), 46 (48) 50 (52), 56 (60) 66 (70) times each round.

There are 5 increase rounds in the chart, and you will increase a total of 38 (40) 42 (44), 46 (48) 50 (52), 56 (60) 66 (70) stitches in each increase round. As the number of stitches in each round increases, you will need to change to a circular needle with a longer cord. I recommend having cords measuring 60, 80, and 100 cm [24 in, 32 in, 40 in] on hand for a comfortable knitting experience.

Note: To avoid jogs in the pattern at the BOR, I recommend slipping the first stitch of the round purlwise with the yarn held in the back on Rounds 12, 14, 17, 19, 24, 29, 34, 37, 40, and 44.

At the end of the chart, you will have increased a total of 190 (200) 210 (220), 230 (240) 250 (260), 280 (300) 330 (350) stitches and you now have a total of 266 (280) 294 (308), 322 (336) 350 (364), 392 (420) 462 (490) stitches.

You can now break your CC yarn.

Short rows

You will now work a series of German short rows to add shape to the yoke. These are optional but I strongly recommend that you do work them. You may find it helpful to use clip-on stitch markers to map out where the short row turns will be.

The short rows as worked as follows:

Short row 1 (RS): Slip BOR marker, knit 66 (70) 73 (77), 80 (84) 87 (91), 98 (105) 115 (122) stitches. Use the last stitch to turn your work using the GSR method.

Short row 2 (WS): Purl to the BOR marker, slip it and then purl 66 (70) 73 (77), 80 (84) 87 (91), 98 (105) 115 (122) stitches. Use the last stitch to turn your work using the GSR method.

You will now repeat the following 2 short rows a total of 2 times, as follows:

Short row 3 (RS): Knit to the previous GSR stitch and knit it, then knit 22 (23) 25 (26), 27 (28) 29 (30), 33 (35) 39 (41) stitches. Use the last stitch to turn your work using the GSR method.

Short row 4 (WS): Purl to the previous GSR stitch and purl it, then purl 22 (23) 25 (26), 27 (28) 29 (30), 33 (35) 39 (41) stitches. Use the last stitch to turn your work using the GSR method.

When you have worked the final WS short row, knit back to the BOR marker.

You will now continue to work the yoke in Stockinette stitch until it measures approximately 20 (20.5) 21 (21.5), 22 (22.5) 22.5 (23), 24 (24.5) 25.5 (26.5) cm [7.75 (8) 8.25 (8.5), 8.75 (8.75) 8.75 (9), 9.5 (9.75) 10 (10.5) in] from the cast-on edge to the live stitches at the BOR, or your preferred length for the yoke.

Divide body and sleeve sections

You will now separate the body and sleeve sections, whilst also casting on new underarm stitches. This is done as follows:

Round 1: Slip BOR marker, knit 40 (43) 45 (47), 50 (52) 54 (57), 61 (65) 71 (75) stitches and then, using the backwards-loop/thumb method, cast on 5 (5) 5 (6), 6 (7) 7 (7), 8 (10) 8 (10) new stitches. Slip the next 53 (55) 57 (60), 62 (65) 67 (69), 74 (80) 89 (95) stitches onto a spare circular needle, stitch holder, or piece of scrap yarn. Knit the next 80 (85) 90 (94), 99 (103) 108 (113), 122 (130) 142 (150) stitches and, again, using the backwards-loop/thumb method, cast on 5 (5) 5 (6), 6 (7) 7 (7), 8 (10) 8 (10) new stitches. Slip the next 53 (55) 57 (60), 62 (65) 67 (69), 74 (80) 89 (95) stitches onto a spare circular needle, stitch holder, or piece of scrap yarn. Knit the remaining 40 (42) 45 (47), 49 (51) 54 (56), 61 (65) 71 (75) stitches.

You now have a total of 170 (180) 190 (200), 210 (220) 230 (240), 260 (280) 300 (320) live body stitches, and 2 sets of 53 (55) 57 (60), 62 (65) 67 (69), 74 (80) 89 (95) resting sleeve stitches.

Body

You will now continue to work in Stockinette stitch (i.e., knit all stitches) until you

work measures 45.5 (46.5) 47.5 (48.5), 49.5 (50.5) 51.5 (52.5), 54.5 (56) 57.5 (59) cm [18 (18.5) 18.75 (19.25), 19.5 (20) 20.25 (20.75), 21.5 (22) 22.75 (23.5) in] when measured from the mid-back cast-on edge, or 5 cm [2 in] shorter than your ideal length.

When you are happy with the length of your work, change to a 3.5-mm circular needle with your preferred cord length and work 5 cm [2 in] in 1x1 rib (i.e., *knit 1, purl 1*). I worked 12 rounds, for reference.

If you would prefer to use a tubular cast-off (which I strongly recommend), you will need to work the following 2 rounds to set up the cast-off:

Round 1: *Knit 1, slip 1 purlwise WYIF* to the end of the round.

Round 2: *Slip 1 purlwise WYIB, purl 1* to the end of the round.

Cast off all stitches using the sewn part of the cast-off (see **Techniques** above).

If you would prefer to use a different cast-off method, make sure to use something that is fairly elastic to ensure a comfortable fit around your hips.

Sleeves (repeat for both sides)

You will now resume working the sleeve stitches that have been resting. Slip the resting 53 (55) 57 (60), 62 (65) 67 (69), 74 (80) 89 (95) sleeve stitches on to a 4.5-mm [US 7] circular needles with a 40- or 60-cm [16- or 24-in] cord (whichever feels most comfortable for you is fine).

To begin, work the following 2 rounds:

Round 1: Locate the mid-point of the underarm cast-on and, from here, pick up and knit 3 (3) 3 (3), 3 (4) 4 (4), 4 (5) 4 (5) stitches. Pick up and knit 1 extra stitch from between the cast-on edge and the resting stitches. Knit the next 53 (55) 57 (60), 62 (65) 67 (69), 74 (80) 89 (95) stitches and then, again, pick up and knit 1 extra stitch from between the resting stitches and the cast-on edge. Pick up and knit another 2 (2) 2 (3), 3 (3) 3 (3), 4 (5) 4 (5) stitches. Place a new BOR marker between the first and last stitch of the round.

Round 2: Slip BOR marker, knit 2 (2) 2 (2), 2 (3) 3 (3), 3 (4) 3 (4) stitches, SSK,

knit until 3 (3) 3 (4), 4 (4) 4 (4), 5 (6) 5 (6) stitches remain in the round, K2tog, knit to the BOR marker *(-2 stitches)*.

You now have a total of 58 (60) 62 (66), 68 (72) 74 (76), 82 (90) 97 (105) stitches.

Note: Round 2 should help to prevent holes forming on either end of the underarm cast-on edge, but you may wish to go back and reinforce these areas of your sweater.

You will now continue to work in Stockinette stitch until your sleeve measures approximately 40 cm [16 in], whilst also working some decreases to give the sleeve some shape.

You will work the following decrease round every 13 (13) 13 (10), 8 (6.5) 5.5 (5.5), 3.5 (2.5) 2.5 (2) cm [5.25 (5.25) 5.25 (4), 3.25 (2.5) 2.25 (2.25), 1.5 (1) 1 (0.75) in] a total of 3 (3) 3 (4), 5 (6) 7 (7), 10 (14) 16 (20) times:

Decrease round: Slip BOR marker, knit 1, K2tog, knit to 3 stitches before the end of the round, SSK, knit 1 *(-2 stitches)*.

Continue working in Stockinette stitch until your sleeve measures approximately 40 cm [16 in], or 5 cm [2 in] shorter than your ideal length.

Note: If you wish to adjust the length of the sleeve to better suit your needs or preferences, you should divide your preferred length (minus 5 cm [2 in] for the cuff) by the number of decrease rounds you will work in order to find the decrease interval.

By the end of the sleeve, you will have decreased a total of 6 (6) 6 (8), 10 (12) 14 (14), 20 (28) 32 (40) stitches and you now have a total of 52 (54) 56 (58), 58 (60) 60 (62), 62 (62) 65 (65) stitches.

Note: Sizes K and L only will need to decrease 1 more stitch at the beginning of the cuff. I recommend starting the first round of the cuff with a K2tog.

When you are happy with the length of your sleeve, change to a 3.5 mm circular needle with your preferred cord length and work 5 cm [2 in] in 1x1 rib (i.e., *knit 1, purl 1*). I worked 12 rounds, for reference.

If you would prefer to use a tubular cast-off (which I strongly recommend), you will need to work the following 2 rounds to set up the cast-off:

Round 1: *Knit 1, slip 1 purlwise WYIF* to the end of the round.

Round 2: *Slip 1 purlwise WYIB, purl 1* to the end of the round.

Cast off all stitches using the sewn part of the cast-off (see **Techniques** above).

If you would prefer to use a different cast-off method, make sure to use something that is fairly elastic to ensure a comfortable fit around your wrists.

Finishing

You can now weave in your ends and wet block your work. You may find it helpful to pin the yoke out to add definition to the colourwork. You may also find that inserting some shirring elastic through the collar will give the garment some extra strength and improve the overall fit.

I hope that you have enjoyed knitting this pattern and wish you a very happy end to the year!

If you require pattern support, please email me at **the.knit.purl.girl2020@gmail.com**. I will try to reply within 1 working week but this may not always be possible.

Make sure to tag me on Instagram @the_knit_purl_girl and use the hashtag **#NovaSweater** so that I can share your creations!

LET'S GET IN TOUCH

Please email for pattern support.
#NovaSweater

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